

Professional Conduct Standards

Document ID	TG-POL-06	Effective	March 1, 2026
Applies to	All Employees (Therapists, Counselors, Coaches)	Owner	Clinical & Compliance Team

At a Glance

Confidentiality	HIPAA-aligned handling of all client information; share only with documented consent, except Emergency Protocol or mandatory reporting.
Boundaries	No dual relationships, no romantic/sexual relationships with current or former clients, platform-only communication, gifts under \$25 only.
Communication	Respond within 24 hours, warm and professional tone always, never respond while impaired.
Violations	First-time minor issues: supervisor coaching. Confidentiality breaches or romantic/sexual boundary violations: immediate suspension pending review.

1. Purpose

This policy sets the standard for how every Togethr employee conducts themselves toward clients, regardless of role. These standards exist to protect clients and to maintain the trust that makes coaching and therapy effective.

2. Confidentiality & Privacy

All client information shared in session, in messages, or in documentation is confidential and handled in a manner consistent with HIPAA, regardless of whether the employee's specific role or license technically requires HIPAA compliance. Client information may only be shared with another provider with the client's documented consent, except where Emergency Protocol (TG-POL-05) or mandatory reporting requirements apply.

- Client data must only be accessed through official Togethr systems — never exported, screenshotted, or stored on personal devices
- Session recordings, where enabled, may only be reviewed by the employee and, if applicable, their clinical supervisor
- Employees must not discuss identifiable client details with anyone outside an official supervision or care-coordination context

3. Boundaries with Clients

- No dual relationships — employees must not provide services to a client with whom they have a personal, business, or family relationship
- No romantic or sexual relationships with current or former clients, under any circumstances, at any point in time
- All communication with clients must occur through official Togethr channels — no personal phone numbers, personal social media, or personal email
- Employees must not accept gifts from clients beyond a nominal token (under \$25 equivalent), and must decline anything more with a clear, kind explanation
- Employees must not solicit clients for services outside the Togethr platform

4. Communication Standards

Employees are expected to respond to client messages within the platform's stated response window (24 hours for non-urgent messages). Tone should remain warm, professional, and non-judgmental at all times, including with clients who are frustrated or in distress. Employees must never respond to a client while impaired by alcohol or any substance.

5. Cultural Competence & Non-Discrimination

Employees must provide equitable, competent care regardless of a client's race, ethnicity, religion, national origin, gender identity, sexual orientation, disability status, or relationship structure (including non-monogamous relationships where legal and consensual). Any employee who does not feel equipped to competently serve a particular client should raise this with their supervisor rather than provide substandard care.

6. Social Media & Public Conduct

Employees representing themselves as Togethr providers on public or social platforms must not discuss client cases, even in de-identified or hypothetical form, in a way that could reasonably be traced back to a real client. Employees should maintain a professional public presence consistent with the trust clients place in the platform.

7. Consequences of Violations

Minor, first-time boundary issues are addressed through supervisor coaching and a documented conversation. Repeated violations, confidentiality breaches, or any boundary violation involving a romantic/sexual relationship with a client result in immediate suspension pending review, and may result in termination and reporting to the relevant licensing board where applicable.

8. Example Scenarios

- A client sends a friend request on personal social media after a positive session. The employee should decline and gently explain the platform-only communication policy.
- A client offers a small thank-you gift, like a handwritten card or a \$15 gift card, at the end of treatment. This falls within the nominal-gift allowance and may be accepted graciously.
- An employee recognizes a client as a distant acquaintance from their personal life at the start of a session. This should be disclosed to a supervisor immediately to determine whether reassignment is appropriate under the dual-relationship policy.
- A former client reaches out romantically six months after their last session. The prohibition on romantic relationships with former clients still applies — this should be declined and reported to a supervisor.

9. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can an employee ever communicate with a client outside the platform?

A: Only in an active safety emergency where platform channels are unavailable. All other communication must stay within official Togethr channels.

Q: What counts as a "dual relationship"?

A: Any relationship with a client outside of the professional coaching/therapy relationship — business partners, mutual close friends, family members, or romantic interests. When in doubt, disclose it to a supervisor.

Q: Is it ever appropriate to share personal opinions about a client's relationship decisions?

A: Employees should help clients think through their own values and decisions rather than impose personal opinions about what the client should do.

10. Related Policies

This document applies across all roles and should be read alongside the scope-of-practice policy for your role (TG-POL-01, TG-POL-02, or TG-POL-03).